



LITTLE MILESTONE CO.

A NICU Journal

For the hardest, most love-filled days

For

Held by





Before You Begin

This journal is just a tool — not one more thing you have to get right. Fill in what helps, skip what doesn't, come back to a page a week later if that's what today allows. There's no correct order and no finish line to rush toward.

It isn't a medical record. It won't replace what your baby's care team documents, and nothing here should stand in for their guidance — it's simply a place to keep track of what matters to *you*: the questions, the small moments, the people helping you, and how you're actually doing.

However long you're here, and however this chapter goes — we're glad you have this to hold onto.

If you need someone to talk to, your NICU's social worker or chaplain is there for exactly this — you don't have to be in crisis to reach out to them.



A Few Details

For your own reference

BABY'S NAME

DATE OF BIRTH

GESTATIONAL AGE AT BIRTH

BIRTH WEIGHT

HOSPITAL / NICU

ADMISSION DATE

PRIMARY ATTENDING

OUR NICU NICKNAME FOR THIS JOURNEY

Daily Log

One row a day, or whenever you have a moment

Daily Log

Continued — duplicate this page for a longer stay

Jot them down the moment you think of them — rounds move fast

Care Team & Contacts

So many names — a place to keep them straight

Feeding & Pumping Log

Daily totals — as exact or as approximate as you need

Milestones

In your own time, in your own order — check off only what applies to you

First time being held

First skin-to-skin (kangaroo care)

Off CPAP / ventilator

First bottle or breastfeeding

Moved to a new room or pod

First bath

First outfit

A weight milestone that mattered to us

Discharge planning begins



A Space for Feelings

Today I want to remember...



Support & Self-Care

Gentle reminders, not a to-do list

- ☐ Eat something today, even if it's small.
- ☐ It's okay to leave the room. It's okay to stay.
- ☐ Ask someone to bring you a change of clothes.
- ☐ You're allowed to have a hard day — or a hard hour, inside a good day.
- ☐ Let someone else answer texts for you today, if you want to.
- ☐ Rest counts, even in small pieces.

PEOPLE HELPING US RIGHT NOW



Siblings at Home

If this applies to your family

WHO'S CARING FOR THEM

HOW THEY'RE DOING

WHAT THEY UNDERSTAND SO FAR

SOMETHING THAT'S HELPED THEM

NOTES



Logistics

The unglamorous but necessary things

PARKING & HOSPITAL LOGISTICS

SOCIAL WORKER / FINANCIAL COUNSELOR

INSURANCE & BILLING NOTES

HOSPITAL RESOURCES WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



Discharge Prep

Whenever that day comes

- ☐ Car seat test completed
- ☐ Newborn screening completed
- ☐ Pediatrician chosen
- ☐ First follow-up appointment scheduled
- ☐ Home equipment arranged, if needed
- ☐ Feeding plan for home confirmed
- ☐ Going-home outfit ready



However this chapter reads,
you showed up for it.

That counts for everything.

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